

Bookend Story Evidence Card Pack

Sixteen paper bookend cards help writers support small fictional story claims with clue details, because lines, evidence sentences, and bookend notes.

Audience: Families, homeschool groups, tutors, and adult-led writing tables for writers ages 7-11.

Format: 16 printable bookend story evidence cards plus adult guide tools, evidence routines, take-home evidence slips, and optional adult prompts

Family-safe printable writing pages for adult-led, offline evidence practice.

\$101

Included

- 16 printable bookend evidence cards
- Adult setup guide
- Fictional evidence safety notes
- Story claim prompts
- First clue prompts
- Second clue prompts
- Because line prompts
- Evidence sentence prompts
- Six adult-led evidence routines
- Ten take-home evidence slips
- Printable PDF and ZIP artifact

Evidence coaching

Bookend Story Evidence Adult Guide:

- Set out one evidence card, six blank paper strips, and a pencil before the adult-led session begins:_____.
- Label the strips story claim, first clue, second clue, because line, evidence sentence, and bookend note:_____.
- Choose one pretend story world and keep every character, place, object, clue, and reason invented:_____.
- Tell the writer that dictated words, adult-scribed words, or independent writing all fit the offline paper-only activity:_____.
- Place the story claim strip at the left edge and the bookend note at the right edge so the invented evidence has a calm start and close:_____.

Facilitation notes

- Start with a small story claim, not a big explanation:_____.
- Ask for the first clue as one pretend detail the writer can point to on paper:_____.
- Ask for the second clue as another invented detail that helps the same story claim:_____.
- Use the because line to connect the two clues before asking for the evidence sentence:_____.
- Close with the bookend note so the writer can name what the evidence helped show in the fictional story:_____.

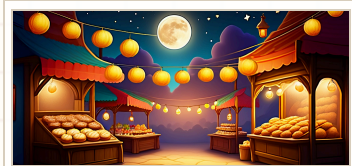
Safety notes

- Use invented characters, broad pretend places, and made-up clue details only:_____.
- Keep the activity offline, paper-only, adult-led, and away from outside audiences:_____.
- Skip any prompt that starts to ask for real names, real place details, or personal facts:_____.
- Keep the evidence sentence about the pretend story, not about a real person or real event:_____.
- Treat the bookend note as a private paper close for this session:_____.

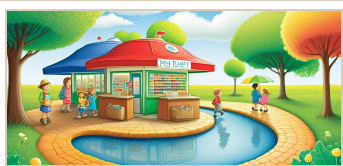
Use one story evidence card at a time. Keep every evidence sentence broad, invented, paper-only, and guided by an adult.

Sixteen evidence card worlds

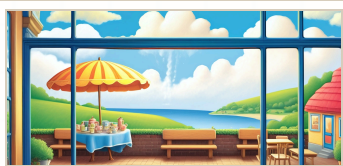
Pick a world image, then name the story claim, first clue, second clue, because line, evidence sentence, and bookend note.



AGES 6-8
Moon Muffin Market



AGES 6-8
Puddle Planet Post Office



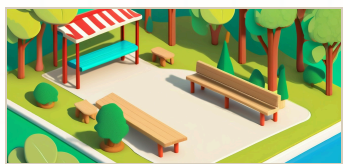
AGES 7-8
Teacup Town Weather Window



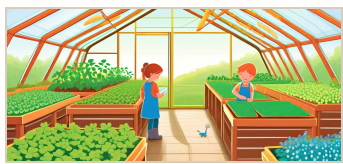
AGES 7-9
Button Bakery Map Mix-Up



AGES 7-9
Penny Path Compass Shop



AGES 7-9
Pocket Park Notice Board



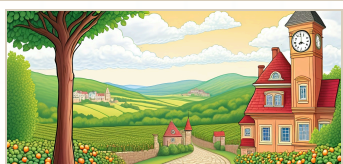
AGES 8-10
Greenhouse Gear Garden



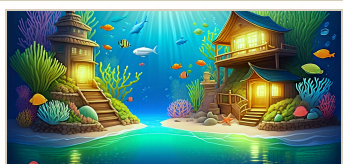
AGES 8-10
Orchard Pulley Post



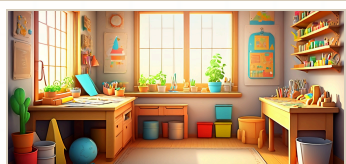
AGES 8-10
Rain Gauge Railway



AGES 8-10
Cloudberry Clocktower



AGES 8-10
Tiny Lantern Reef



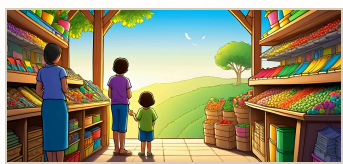
AGES 10-11
Almost Invention Workshop



AGES 10-11
Clue Label Tower Museum



AGES 10-11
Compass Craft Academy



AGES 10-11
Margin Note Market



AGES 10-11
Pencil Dragon Academy

Choose the story evidence routine

USE WHEN THE WRITER NEEDS ONE SIMPLE IDEA TO HOLD THE EVIDENCE PATH: Story Claim Bookend: _____. 1. The adult places the story claim strip at the left edge of the workspace: _____. 2. The adult asks what small idea could be true inside the pretend story: _____. 3. The writer completes this line: My story claim is _____. 4. The adult rereads the story claim and saves it for the evidence sentence: _____.	USE WHEN THE STORY CLAIM NEEDS ONE INVENTED DETAIL TO BEGIN THE EVIDENCE PATH: First Clue Finder: _____. 1. The adult points to the first clue strip and asks what pretend detail helps the story claim: _____. 2. The writer chooses one object, action, sound, color, sign, or tiny change from the fictional world: _____. 3. The writer completes this line: My first clue is _____. 4. The adult places the first clue beside the story claim without adding real details: _____.
USE WHEN THE WRITER HAS ONE CLUE AND NEEDS ANOTHER CLUE THAT SUPPORTS THE SAME STORY CLAIM: Second Clue Pair: _____. 1. The adult rereads the story claim and first clue in order: _____. 2. The writer names a different invented detail that points toward the same idea: _____. 3. The writer completes this line: My second clue is _____. 4. The adult checks that the second clue helps the same story claim instead of starting a new idea: _____.	USE WHEN THE CLUES ARE READY BUT THE CONNECTION IS STILL MISSING: Because Line Link: _____. 1. The adult lays the first clue and second clue strips between the story claim and the blank because line: _____. 2. The adult asks why both clues help the story claim in the pretend story: _____. 3. The writer completes this line: These clues help because _____. 4. The adult trims the because line to one clear reason and keeps it fictional: _____.
USE WHEN THE WRITER IS READY TO COMBINE THE STORY CLAIM, TWO CLUES, AND BECAUSE LINE: Evidence Sentence Builder: _____. 1. The adult reads the story claim, first clue, second clue, and because line in order: _____. 2. The writer points to the strip that should start the evidence sentence: _____. 3. The writer completes this line: My evidence sentence is _____. 4. The adult helps keep the evidence sentence to one clear fictional story sentence: _____.	USE AT THE END OF A PAPER SESSION TO CLOSE THE EVIDENCE PATH NEATLY: Bookend Note Close: _____. 1. The adult places the bookend note strip at the right edge of the workspace: _____. 2. The adult rereads the evidence sentence without adding new facts: _____. 3. The writer completes this line: My bookend note says _____. 4. The adult stacks the strips in order for a private paper folder: _____.

Try one evidence path later

TAKE-HOME EVIDENCE SLIP Story Claim Slip My story claim is _____. Ask for one small idea that could be true inside the pretend story.	TAKE-HOME EVIDENCE SLIP First Clue Slip My first clue is _____. Choose one invented detail that helps the story claim.
TAKE-HOME EVIDENCE SLIP Second Clue Slip My second clue is _____. Choose a different pretend detail that helps the same story claim.	TAKE-HOME EVIDENCE SLIP Because Line Slip These clues help because _____. Use one plain reason that stays inside the fictional story.
TAKE-HOME EVIDENCE SLIP Evidence Sentence Slip My evidence sentence is _____. Combine the story claim, first clue, second clue, and because line in one sentence.	TAKE-HOME EVIDENCE SLIP Bookend Note Slip My bookend note says _____. Close with one short note about what the evidence helped show.
TAKE-HOME EVIDENCE SLIP Clue Match Slip The first clue and second clue both help the story claim because _____. Reread both clue strips before filling the blank.	TAKE-HOME EVIDENCE SLIP Claim Check Slip The story claim still fits after I read the clues: _____. Use this as a quiet paper check, not a correction mark.
TAKE-HOME EVIDENCE SLIP Sentence Shorten Slip One extra detail I can leave off the evidence sentence is _____. Frame this as paper sorting so the sentence stays clear.	TAKE-HOME EVIDENCE SLIP Bookend Path Slip My paper path goes story claim, first clue, second clue, because line, evidence sentence, bookend note: _____. Close by stacking the strips in order for another adult-led session.

Optional adult prompts

- Which story claim feels small enough for one paper strip: _____.
- What first clue can the writer invent without using real people or real places: _____.
- What second clue helps the same story claim in a different way: _____.
- Which clue should the adult reread before the because line: _____.
- How can the because line use plain words and stay inside the pretend story: _____.
- What evidence sentence uses the story claim, first clue, second clue, and because line: _____.
- What bookend note gives the evidence path a calm paper close: _____.
- Which strip can stay blank until the writer is ready to dictate or write it: _____.

Moon Muffin Market Bookend Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out one blank page, pencil, and two paper bookend marks before the Moon Muffin Market evidence work: _____.

Writer: invent a moon market helper, a stall sign, and two tiny clues while every answer stays made up: _____.



Moon Muffin Market

Story claim story claim: write one idea about what the moon market helper learns from the pretend market problem: _____ _____	First clue first clue: write one small moon market detail that helps support the story claim: _____ _____
Second clue second clue: write one different moon market detail that also points to the story claim: _____ _____	Because line because line: write why the first clue and second clue make the story claim make sense: _____ _____
Evidence sentence evidence sentence: write one sentence that uses the story claim, both clues, and the because line: _____ _____	Bookend note bookend note: write a closing paper note that brings the story claim back at the end: _____ _____

Quiet option: fill only the story claim, first clue, and bookend note blanks first: _____.

Take-home line: keep this paper evidence card and add one new moon market clue later: _____.

Puddle Planet Post Office Bookend Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: place a blank page, pencil, and two paper bookend marks beside the puddle planet card: _____.

Writer: make up the post office desk, puddle stamps, and a helper who studies two invented clues on paper: _____.



Puddle Planet Post Office

Story claim story claim: write one idea about what the helper understands when a puddle stamp keeps changing shape: _____.	First clue first clue: write one puddle stamp, planet pouch, or desk mark that supports the story claim: _____.
Second clue second clue: write one new clue from another part of the pretend post office: _____.	Because line because line: write why those two clues help explain the story claim: _____.
Evidence sentence evidence sentence: write one sentence that tells the story claim and names both clue details: _____.	Bookend note bookend note: write a short ending note that returns to the puddle stamp clue: _____.

Quiet option: fill the first clue and second clue first, then add the story claim: _____.

Take-home line: keep this paper evidence card and add one new puddle planet detail later: _____.

Teacup Town Weather Window Bookend Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: set a blank page, pencil, and two paper bookend marks near the weather-window prompt: _____.

Writer: invent a teacup window, tiny weather signal, and helper while all evidence stays fictional: _____.



Teacup Town Weather Window

Story claim story claim: write one idea about what the helper figures out when the weather window changes: _____ _____	First clue first clue: write one window mark, cloud shape, or tiny signal that points toward the story claim: _____ _____
Second clue second clue: write one different weather-window detail that supports the same story claim: _____ _____	Because line because line: write why both clues make the helper's story claim stronger: _____ _____
Evidence sentence evidence sentence: write one sentence that links the story claim to the first clue and second clue: _____ _____	Bookend note bookend note: write a final paper note that echoes the weather-window claim: _____ _____

Quiet option: fill only the story claim, because line, and evidence sentence blanks first: _____. **Take-home line:** keep this paper evidence card and add one new weather-window clue later: _____.

Button Bakery Map Mix-Up Bookend Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: place one blank page, pencil, and two paper bookend marks beside the button map card: _____.

Writer: invent button trays, a pretend map, and a helper who compares two clues on paper: _____.



Button Bakery Map Mix-Up

Story claim
story claim: write one idea about how the helper solves the button map mix-up: _____.

Second clue
second clue: write another button map detail that points to the same story claim: _____.

Evidence sentence
evidence sentence: write one sentence that explains the story claim with both clues: _____.

First clue
first clue: write one button shape, tray mark, or map path that supports the story claim: _____.

Because line
because line: write why the two clue details make the helper's choice make sense: _____.

Bookend note
bookend note: write a closing paper note that brings the map clue back to the story claim: _____.

Quiet option: fill the two clue blanks first, then write the evidence sentence: _____.

Take-home line: keep this paper evidence card and add one new button map clue later: _____.

Penny Path Compass Shop Bookend Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out a blank page, pencil, and two paper bookend marks for the compass shop evidence card: _____.

Writer: make up a penny path, compass counter, and helper while every clue stays invented and paper-only: _____.



Penny Path Compass Shop

Story claim story claim: write one idea about what the helper learns from the compass path problem: _____ _____	First clue first clue: write one penny mark, pointer turn, or counter sign that supports the story claim: _____ _____
Second clue second clue: write one different compass shop clue that supports the same claim: _____ _____ _____	Because line because line: write why the two clues support the helper's trust in the clearer path: _____ _____ _____
Evidence sentence evidence sentence: write one sentence that uses the story claim, first clue, and second clue together: _____ _____	Bookend note bookend note: write a final note that returns to the penny path at the end of the paper: _____ _____

Quiet option: fill only the first clue, because line, and bookend note blanks first: _____. **Take-home line:** keep this paper evidence card and add one new compass shop clue later: _____.

Pocket Park Notice Board Bookend Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: place a blank page, pencil, and two paper bookend marks near the pocket park card: _____.

Writer: invent a tiny park board, folded signs, and a helper who studies two paper clues: _____.



Pocket Park Notice Board

Story claim story claim: write one idea about what the helper understands when the park board signs do not match: _____ _____	First clue first clue: write one folded sign, path mark, or park board pin that supports the story claim: _____ _____
Second clue second clue: write one different pocket park detail that gives more support for the claim: _____ _____	Because line because line: write why both clues help the helper understand the board problem: _____ _____
Evidence sentence evidence sentence: write one sentence that names the story claim and includes the two clue details: _____ _____	Bookend note bookend note: write a final paper note that returns to the park board clue: _____ _____

Quiet option: fill the story claim and bookend note first, then add one clue: _____. **Take-home line:** keep this paper evidence card and add one new pocket park clue later: _____.

Greenhouse Gear Garden Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out a blank evidence card, pencil, and pretend gear garden sketch; keep every clue invented on paper: _____.

Writer: invent a greenhouse keeper who notices paper gears, glass-pane shadows, and a small garden mystery inside the story: _____.



Greenhouse Gear Garden

Story claim
Story claim: what small idea about the greenhouse keeper can your two clue details support inside the story?

Second clue
Second clue: choose a different greenhouse detail that points to the same story claim:

Evidence sentence
Evidence sentence: write one sentence using the story claim, first clue, second clue, and because line:

First clue
First clue: choose one gear squeak, window glint, or seedling tag that supports the story claim:

Because line
Because line: connect both clue details to the story claim in one clear reason: _____

Bookend note
Bookend note: write a short final note that reminds the writer how the two clues hold up the story claim:

Quiet option: adult points to two pretend greenhouse details, and the writer fills only the because line blank: _____. **Take-home line:** keep this greenhouse evidence card for one later adult-led offline paper story pass: _____.

Orchard Pulley Post Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: provide a blank card, pencil, and pretend pulley-post diagram; keep the orchard task imaginary and calm: _____.

Writer: invent a pulley post helper who studies ropes, basket marks, and orchard signs drawn only on paper: _____.



Orchard Pulley Post

Story claim
Story claim: what do the clue details help show about the pulley post helper's careful plan?

First clue
First clue: pick one rope loop, pulley creak, or basket mark that supports the story claim:

Second clue
Second clue: add one orchard sign, post notch, or paper path mark that supports the same story claim:

Because line
Because line: explain why the first clue and second clue both point toward the story claim:

Evidence sentence
Evidence sentence: combine the story claim with both clues and the because line in one sentence:

Bookend note
Bookend note: close the card with a short note about how the clue details steady the story claim:

Quiet option: adult reads the story claim, and the writer chooses only a first clue and second clue: _____. **Take-home line:** save the orchard pulley evidence card for another paper-only story check with an adult: _____.

Rain Gauge Railway Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: place a blank evidence card beside a pencil and a pretend railway weather chart drawn on paper: _____.

Writer: invent a rail cart helper who notices rain marks, signal cards, and track-side clues in a made-up story: _____.



Rain Gauge Railway

Story claim Story claim: what idea about the rail cart helper can your rain gauge clues support? _____ _____	First clue First clue: choose one rain line, gauge tick, or signal-card mark that supports the story claim: _____ _____
Second clue Second clue: choose a different railway detail that also supports the story claim: _____. _____ _____	Because line Because line: write why the first clue and second clue belong with the same story claim: _____ _____
Evidence sentence Evidence sentence: write one full sentence that uses the story claim and both clue details: _____ _____	Bookend note Bookend note: add a short note that brings the rain gauge clue trail back to the story claim: _____ _____

Quiet option: adult names two pretend railway details, and the writer fills only the story claim blank: _____. **Take-home line:** keep the rain gauge railway card for a later adult-led offline paper evidence sentence: _____.

Cloudberry Clocktower Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: set out a blank card, pencil, and pretend clocktower sketch; keep all clock marks and cloudberry details fictional: _____.

Writer: invent a clocktower keeper who studies bell rings, stair marks, and cloudberry-colored clouds inside the story: _____.



Cloudberry Clocktower

Story claim
Story claim: what can the two clue details show about the clocktower keeper's choice?

Second clue
Second clue: choose one cloudberry-colored cloud, tower shadow, or window note that supports the same story claim: _____

Evidence sentence
Evidence sentence: write one sentence that joins the story claim, two clues, and because line:

First clue
First clue: choose one bell ring, clock hand pause, or stair mark that supports the story claim:

Because line
Because line: explain how the first clue and second clue work together to support the story claim:

Bookend note
Bookend note: write a short closing note that holds the clocktower clues beside the story claim:

Quiet option: adult circles the two clue blanks, and the writer fills only the evidence sentence blank: _____. **Take-home line:** save this clocktower evidence card for one calm paper-only revisit with an adult: _____.

Tiny Lantern Reef Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult: provide a blank evidence card, pencil, and pretend reef lantern sketch; keep the reef gentle and imaginary: _____.

Writer: invent a lantern reef guide who follows glow marks, shell patterns, and paper wave lines inside the story: _____.



Tiny Lantern Reef

Story claim

Story claim: what idea about the lantern reef guide can your two clue details support?

_____.

Second clue

Second clue: choose a different reef detail that supports the same story claim: _____.

_____.

Evidence sentence

Evidence sentence: turn the story claim, first clue, second clue, and because line into one sentence:

_____.

First clue

First clue: choose one lantern glow, shell pattern, or wave-line mark that supports the story claim:

_____.

Because line

Because line: write why the first clue and second clue both point to the story claim: _____.

_____.

Bookend note

Bookend note: end with a short note about how the two reef clues hold the story claim in place:

_____.

Quiet option: adult reads the two clue prompts, and the writer fills only the bookend note blank: _____. **Take-home line:** keep the tiny lantern reef card for one later adult-led offline paper story pass: _____.

Almost Invention Workshop Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult-led fictional offline paper-only setup: place this card, a pencil, and two blank paper part tags beside a pretend workshop sketch: _____.

Fill the blanks for a made-up Almost Invention Workshop story; use invented clues only and keep the story calm: _____.



Almost Invention Workshop

Story claim story claim: The almost invention works best when the maker learns _____.	First clue first clue: What workshop detail first supports the story claim, such as a wobbling gear, folded lever, or loose paper spring: _____.
Second clue second clue: What later detail supports the same story claim from a different angle: _____.	Because line because line: These two clues support the story claim because _____.
Evidence sentence evidence sentence: Write one evidence sentence that uses the first clue and second clue to support the story claim: _____.	Bookend note bookend note: End the card by restating the story claim in a shorter workshop note: _____.

quiet option: Fill only the story claim and first clue first, then add the because line later: _____.

take-home line: Save the paper card and add one new workshop clue on a blank slip later: _____.

Clue Label Tower Museum Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult-led fictional offline paper-only setup: place this card, a pencil, and three blank clue labels beside a pretend tower stack: _____.

Fill the blanks for a made-up Clue Label Tower Museum story; keep each label and clue invented: _____.



Clue Label Tower Museum

Story claim story claim: The tower keeper understands the clue best after _____.	First clue first clue: What early tower detail supports the story claim, such as a tilted label, silver tag, or narrow shelf mark: _____.
Second clue second clue: What later tower detail supports the same story claim without copying the first clue: _____.	Because line because line: These two clues support the story claim because _____.
Evidence sentence evidence sentence: Write one evidence sentence that connects the first clue and second clue to the story claim: _____.	Bookend note bookend note: End the card with a short tower note that returns to the story claim: _____.

quiet option: Fill the first clue, second clue, and because line before writing the full evidence sentence: _____.

take-home line: Save the paper card and add one clearer clue label on another slip later: _____.

Compass Craft Academy Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult-led fictional offline paper-only setup: place this card, a pencil, and a blank paper compass beside four pretend direction marks: _____.

Fill the blanks for a made-up Compass Craft Academy story; use invented place names and paper clues only: _____.



Compass Craft Academy

Story claim
story claim: The compass crafter finds the right direction by _____.

First clue
first clue: What first compass detail supports the story claim, such as a bent needle mark, folded arrow, or smudged route ring: _____.

Second clue
second clue: What second compass detail supports the same story claim later in the story: _____.

Because line
because line: These two clues support the story claim because _____.

Evidence sentence
evidence sentence: Write one evidence sentence that uses both compass clues to support the story claim: _____.

Bookend note
bookend note: End the card by naming how the story claim points back to the first compass clue: _____.

quiet option: Fill the story claim and because line first, then choose the two compass clues: _____.

take-home line: Save the paper card and add one extra compass craft detail later: _____.

Margin Note Market Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult-led fictional offline paper-only setup: place this card, a pencil, and three blank margin slips beside a pretend paper booth row: _____.

Fill the blanks for a made-up Margin Note Market story; keep the notes invented and use only paper details: _____.



Margin Note Market

Story claim
story claim: The margin note helper solves the mix-up by noticing _____.

First clue
first clue: What first margin detail supports the story claim, such as a sideways note, tiny arrow, or crossed-out booth mark: _____.

Second clue
second clue: What second margin detail supports the same story claim in a new part of the market: _____.

Because line
because line: These two clues support the story claim because _____.

Evidence sentence
evidence sentence: Write one evidence sentence that uses the first clue and second clue to explain the story claim: _____.

Bookend note
bookend note: End the card with a short market note that returns to the story claim: _____.

quiet option: Fill only the two clue prompts first, then write the story claim after them: _____.

take-home line: Save the paper card and add one new margin note clue on a fresh slip later: _____.

Pencil Dragon Academy Story Evidence Card

Adult setup: Adult-led fictional offline paper-only setup: place this card, a pencil, and two blank scale-shaped paper slips beside a pretend academy arch:
_____.

Fill the blanks for a made-up Pencil Dragon Academy story; keep the dragon gentle, invented, and paper-only: _____.



Pencil Dragon Academy

Story claim story claim: The pencil dragon helps the academy when it learns _____.	First clue first clue: What first academy detail supports the story claim, such as a curled pencil mark, paper scale, or careful wing sketch: _____.
Second clue second clue: What second academy detail supports the same story claim near the end of the story: _____.	Because line because line: These two clues support the story claim because _____.
Evidence sentence evidence sentence: Write one evidence sentence that links the first clue and second clue to the story claim: _____.	Bookend note bookend note: End the card by restating the story claim as a short academy note: _____.

quiet option: Fill the story claim, first clue, and second clue before writing the evidence sentence: _____, **take-home line:** Save the paper card and add one calmer pencil dragon clue later: _____.